

The Effect of Expected Income on Individual Migration Decisions

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September 22, 2025

Roadmap

- 1 Background on Migration
- 2 Story & Key Findings
- 3 Data
- 4 Empirical Strategy
- 5 Results
- 6 Alternative Specifications
- 7 Conclusion

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Models of Migration

- Migration models are used to estimate how and why agents move within an economy
- Typically used to look at isolated migration events, which may be too shallow of a viewpoint

Contribution (Short Discussion)

- **What's new:** Develops a tractable econometric model focusing on expected income's influence on migration which allows for dynamic decision making
- **Why it matters:** Adds possibility of both repeat and return migration, creating a context for this model to solve a job-search problem
- Using data from NLSY, gain an understanding of the motives behind and patterns exhibited by movers in the framework of this model

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Paper's Story / Key Findings

- The paper aims to look at white men with high school education, utilizing the NLSY to track agents through time
- Expected income prospects are a major contributor to interstate migration decisions
- Further, there is evidence of geographic factors taking place once income realization is met, and the current location is found to be suboptimal
- **Key quantitative takeaways** (numbers to remember).

Main Results — One-Slide Overview

- Very short preview of signs and magnitudes.
- Brief intuition for the result.

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Data: Sources & Coverage

- Hospital data (coverage, time, variables).
- Geographic data (units, merges).
- Worker data (sample definition).

Process of Use (for Each Data Type)

- Cleaning and harmonization steps.
- Linkage logic across sources.
- Key variable definitions.

Table: Summary Statistics (Illustrative)

Group	Mean	SD	N
Hospitals			
Geographies			
Workers			

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Model / Estimating Equation

$$y_{it} = \beta \text{Treat}_{it} + \gamma X_{it} + \alpha_i + \tau_t + \varepsilon_{it} \quad (1)$$

- Units, timing, FE, SEs.
- Interpretation of β and threats to ID.

Summary Statistics & Balance

Table: Summary / Balance (Illustrative)

Variable	Control	Treat	Diff
Outcome (baseline)			
Covariate A			
Covariate B			

Treatment vs. Control (Definition)

- Operational definition of **treatment** and **control**.
- Timing / exposure, staggered adoption if any.
- Sample restrictions and measurement windows.

Alternative Specifications — Preview

- Heterogeneity (hospital size, region, worker type).
- Functional form variants / additional controls.
- Event study / placebo / robustness roadmap.

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Main Results: Table

Table: Main Specification (Illustrative)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Treat				
Controls				
FE				
N				
R^2				

:

Side-by-Side Comparisons

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Robustness / Alternative Specs

- Sensitivity to windows / bandwidths.
- Alternative outcomes / subsamples.
- Placebo and permutation checks.

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Conclusion

- **What we learned** — 2–3 bullets.
- **Policy/economic implications.**
- **Limitations** and next steps.

Thank You

Questions?

Roadmap

8 Backup

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Data Details

- Construction and variable definitions.
- Additional balance / coverage checks.